

Manual Publish for Approval

Operator guide — publish a design (DXF or image) and send a customer an approval link, from scratch on a new computer (Windows, macOS, or Linux).

What this is

This is the manual, command-line way to send a customer a design for approval — the same result as tidyCAD's **Send for Approval** button, but runnable from any computer without tidyCAD. You give it a design file; it attaches a preview to the drawer, records a versioned revision in the change log, sets the drawer to **pending approval**, and prints the link you send to your customer.

Use it for a hand-made design, a quick re-publish, or any time you are not in tidyCAD. If you *are* in tidyCAD, just click **Send for Approval** instead.

The link is always the same shape

Every drawer's approval link is just its id: `https://thetidytool.com/approve/?id=<drawer-id>`. The customer opens it on a phone, reviews the preview, types their name, and Approves or Requests changes.

Before you start (about 15 minutes)

- A computer running Windows, macOS, or Linux with internet access.
- Your GitHub access (to get the code).
- The TidyTool Supabase **service-role key** — a secret key. Where to find it is in Step 4.
- A design file: a **.dxf** (it will be rendered to a preview) and/or a **.png / .jpg** image.

Step 1 — Install Python 3

The tool needs Python 3.10 or newer.

Windows

Install from the Microsoft Store (search “Python 3”) or python.org. During the python.org installer, tick “**Add python.exe to PATH**”.

macOS

```
# Recommended: Homebrew (https://brew.sh)
brew install python

# Verify
python3 --version
```

Linux (Debian/Ubuntu)

```
sudo apt update && sudo apt install -y python3 python3-venv python3-pip git
python3 --version
```

Step 2 — Get the code

Clone the website repository (the tool lives in its `tools/` folder). If you don't have Git, install it from git-scm.com (macOS/Windows) or with your package manager.

```
git clone https://github.com/tidytool/tidytool_webpage.git
cd tidytool_webpage/tools
```

No Git? On GitHub click **Code** → **Download ZIP**, unzip it, and open a terminal in the `tidytool_webpage/tools` folder.

Step 3 — Set up the environment

Create an isolated Python environment and install the dependencies. Run these from the `tools/` folder.

macOS / Linux

```
python3 -m venv .venv
source .venv/bin/activate
pip install -r requirements.txt
```

Windows (PowerShell)

```
python -m venv .venv
.venv\Scripts\Activate.ps1
pip install -r requirements.txt
```

You'll know it worked when your prompt shows `(.venv)` and the install finishes without errors.

Step 4 — Add your credentials

The tool authenticates with two values. The service-role key is a **secret** — treat it like a password.

Where to find the service-role key

In the Supabase dashboard: **Project Settings** → **API** → **Project API keys** → `service_role` (click *Reveal*, then copy). It is **not** the anon key.

Set them for your session

macOS / Linux:

```
export SUPABASE_URL="https://tkrrvpoupekrjqditupi.supabase.co"
export SUPABASE_SERVICE_ROLE_KEY="paste-your-service-role-key-here"
```

Windows (PowerShell):

```
$env:SUPABASE_URL="https://tkrrvpoupekrjqditupi.supabase.co"
$env:SUPABASE_SERVICE_ROLE_KEY="paste-your-service-role-key-here"
```

Keep the key out of the repo

Never paste the service-role key into a file you commit. The environment variables above last only for the current terminal session, which is the safest option. If you prefer a reusable `.env` file, make sure it is git-ignored.

Step 5 — Publish a design

Run the tool with your design file and a target drawer. Pick the line that matches your case.

A) Existing drawer (e.g. created by tidyCAM), publish a DXF

```
python publish_for_approval.py --dxf ./design.dxf --drawer-id <drawer-uuid>
```

B) New drawer from a ready-made image (photo or rendered design)

```
python publish_for_approval.py --image ./design.png --create --nickname "BTECH Capstone"
```

C) Use an image as the preview AND attach the DXF snapshot

```
python publish_for_approval.py --image ./design.png --dxf ./design.dxf --drawer-id <drawer-uuid>
```

Options

- `--dxf PATH` — a `.dxf`; it is rendered to the preview and stored as the revision's CAD snapshot.
- `--image PATH` — a `.png/.jpg` used directly as the preview (wins over a rendered DXF).
- `--drawer-id UUID` — publish to an existing drawer · `--create --nickname "..."` — make a new one.
- `--note "..."` — a note shown in the change log · `--order-id UUID` — link a new drawer to an order.
- `--dpi 150` — sharper DXF preview (default 120). Keep previews under ~400 KB for fast phone loads.

On success the tool prints the revision and the approval link, for example:

```
5/5 Done.
Published design_revised (revision 2). Drawer is now PENDING approval.
Send this link to the customer:
https://thetidytool.com/approve/?id=7698c0de-8309-407b-9849-80b050195091
```

Step 6 — Send it, and what happens next

- Copy the printed link and send it to your customer (text/email).
- They open it on a phone, review the preview, type their name, and tap **Approve** or **Request changes**.
- You get a **Discord notification**, and the drawer status + change log update automatically.
- Need a revision? Re-run the tool with the new design — it stores a new revision, flips the drawer back to pending, and the customer can re-approve at the **same link**. Every revision is kept in the history.

Troubleshooting

If you see...	Do this
permission denied for function log_design_revision	Your key is the anon key, not the service-role key. Recheck Step 4.
environment variable SUPABASE_... is not set	Re-run the export/\$env commands in Step 4 in this same terminal window.
ModuleNotFoundError / command not found: python	Activate the venv (Step 3) and confirm Python is installed (Step 1).
no drawer with id ...	Double-check the --drawer-id, or use --create to make a new drawer.
upload failed (HTTP 4xx)	Usually a wrong key or bucket; confirm the service-role key and SUPABASE_URL.

Security reminder

The service-role key can read and write the whole project. Don't share it, don't commit it, and only run this tool on a computer you trust.